

Security Deposit Policy

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1. Purpose and Scope

This policy sets out DataCompany's requirements for the collection, holding, application and return of security deposits for all residential tenancies. It is designed to protect both tenants and DataCompany by ensuring deposits are handled transparently and fairly. All tenants are required to pay a security deposit as a condition of their tenancy commencing.

2. Deposit Amount

Property Type	Standard Deposit	Notes
Single room (bedsit / studio)	Equal to 1 month's rent	Minimum USD 150
1-bedroom apartment	Equal to 1 month's rent	
2-bedroom apartment	Equal to 1 month's rent	
3-bedroom house or larger	Equal to 1 month's rent	May be increased with 30 days notice for high-risk applications
Furnished property (premium)	Equal to 1.5 months' rent	Additional amount covers furnishings

DataCompany does not charge a deposit exceeding two months' rent under any circumstances. The deposit amount is confirmed in writing in the Tenancy Agreement.

3. Payment of Deposit

- The security deposit must be paid in full prior to or on the date of tenancy commencement.
- The deposit must be paid by bank transfer, EcoCash or cash at the DataCompany office. Cheques are not accepted for deposits.
- A deposit receipt will be issued within 24 hours of cleared funds being received.
- The tenancy will not commence, and keys will not be released, until the deposit is confirmed as received.
- In exceptional circumstances, a payment plan for the deposit may be considered by the Housing Manager. This must be agreed in writing before the tenancy starts and is not a standard entitlement.

4. Holding and Protection of Deposits

DataCompany holds all security deposits in a dedicated client account separate from operational funds. Deposits are ring-fenced and are not used for any operational purpose during the tenancy. DataCompany maintains full records of all deposits received, held and returned. Tenants may request confirmation of deposit

holding at any time.

5. Deductions from Deposit

At the end of the tenancy, DataCompany may make deductions from the deposit for the following reasons, supported by photographic and written evidence:

Deduction Category	Examples	Evidence Required
Damage beyond fair wear and tear	Holes in walls, broken fixtures, stained carpets	Photos, contractor quotes or invoices
Unpaid rent or charges	Outstanding rent balance, unpaid service charges	Rent account statement
Cleaning	Property left in an unclean state requiring professional cleaning	Cleaning invoice and comparison photos
Missing items (furnished properties)	Missing furniture, appliances or inventory items	Signed inventory schedule
Unauthorised alterations	Unapproved painting, structural modifications	Photographs, contractor assessment
Abandoned property disposal	Removal of items left by tenant after vacating	Disposal invoice

Fair wear and tear refers to the gradual deterioration of a property through normal daily use. DataCompany will not make deductions for minor scuffs, faded paintwork consistent with the tenancy length, or natural carpet wear in areas of regular foot traffic.

6. Return of Deposit

DataCompany will process the deposit return within 14 working days of the tenancy end date, subject to the property inspection being completed and all keys returned. The process is as follows:

- A post-departure inspection is carried out within 3 working days of vacating.
- A deposit settlement statement is prepared, listing any proposed deductions with supporting evidence.
- The statement is sent to the tenant's registered email address or last known address.
- The tenant has 10 working days to dispute any proposed deduction in writing.
- Where no dispute is raised, the net balance is transferred to the tenant's nominated bank account.
- Where a dispute is raised, the matter is handled under DC-POL-009 (Complaints and Dispute Resolution Policy).

7. Disputes Regarding Deposit Deductions

Any dispute regarding deposit deductions that cannot be resolved through DataCompany's internal complaints process may be escalated to the Zimbabwe Housing Tribunal or a legally qualified arbitrator. DataCompany accepts the outcome of any lawfully constituted adjudication. Tenants retain the right to pursue civil legal action at any stage.